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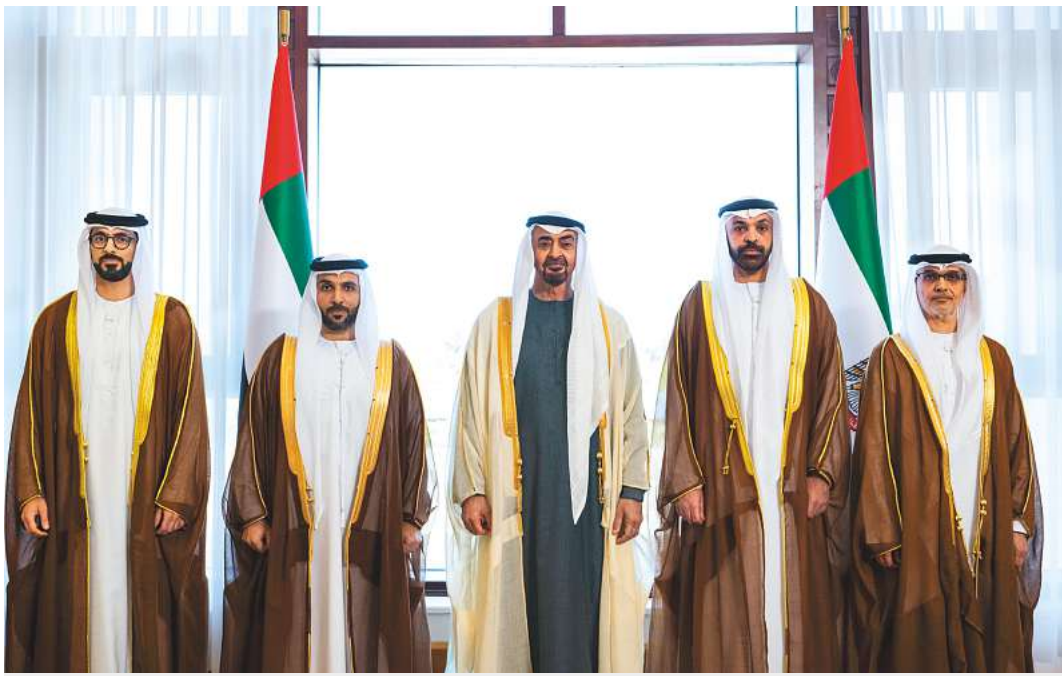
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PRESIDENT WITNESSES SWEARING-IN OF UAE AMBASSADORS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan witnessed the swearing-in of newly-appointed UAE ambassadors. Those who took the oath were Omar Rashid Matar Saeed Al Neyadi, Ambassador to Costa Rica; Mohammed Ahmed Bandoq Al Qamzi, Ambassador to the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN); Mohammed Matar Butti Al Khailli, Ambassador to Ukraine and Fahad Abdulrahman Ali Al Bishr, Ambassador to Uganda.

WAM

Flexibility key as students return to classrooms in UAE

School bus services across all public and private schools in the UAE to resume today

DUBAI
BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

Regular classes on campuses will resume in all nurseries, kindergartens, and public and private schools in the UAE today, according to the UAE's Ministry of Education (MoE).

While most schools are set to welcome students back to classrooms, flexibility will remain a key part of the transition. Dubai's Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) said returns will be carefully managed, with approvals granted only after schools meet strict health and safety requirements.

Schools and universities may continue to offer a mix of on-site and distance learning to accommodate the needs of their communities.

Additionally, the UAE's Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research announced that all public and private higher education institutions will resume in-person learning starting today.

Hybrid model

Schools and universities may continue to offer a mix of on-site and distance learning to accommodate the needs of their communities. However, KHDA has clarified that teachers will not be required

to conduct in-person and remote classes simultaneously.

Parents have also been advised to follow their child's school announcements for the latest updates.

Private early childhood centres in Dubai have gradually returned to on-site learning from last Thursday starting with those in government and commercial buildings, KHDA announced on Tuesday.

Priority will be given to these nurseries, while others can continue offering home-based childcare under approved rules.

School bus services across all public and private schools in the UAE will also resume today, following ongoing assessments by national emergency and education authorities. Transport services will also resume in Sharjah and Ajman from the same date.

SEE ALSO P2

Dubai rents steady as Q1 data shows market stability

Strong demand, fewer cancellations and clear rules keep rental sector on track

DUBAI
BY BALARAM MENON
Senior Web Editor

Stable demand, fewer contract cancellations and continued investor confidence helped Dubai's rental market to remain steady in the first quarter of 2026.

Figures from the Dubai Land Department show that rental contracts worth Dh32.2 billion were signed between January and March, underlining consistent activity across the market. A total of 118,385 new rental contracts were recorded during the quarter, alongside 135,607 renewals. The high

number of renewals suggests tenants are choosing to stay put, reflecting a level of comfort and trust in the market.

Cancellations drop

At the same time, contract cancellations dropped by 25 per cent — a key sign that the market is becoming more stable, with fewer sudden exits or disputes between landlords and tenants. The number of registered real estate offices rose to 10,200, indicating strong participation from agencies and service providers.

In addition, 3,599 real estate licences were issued across different activities. Brokerage services dominated the list, with 1,564 licences for sales and purchases, followed by 928 for leasing. The figures suggest Dubai's rental market is holding firm, backed by clear regulations and steady economic conditions.

TRUMP UPS PRESSURE, GIVES IRAN 'LAST CHANCE' AS TALKS RESUME

Hormuz firing total violation of truce, he says

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump has sharply escalated rhetoric against Iran, threatening to destroy the country's critical infrastructure while announcing that American negotiators will head to Pakistan for a fresh round of talks.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump accused Iran of violating the ceasefire in the Strait of Hormuz, claiming Iranian forces had opened fire on vessels. "Iran decided to fire bullets yesterday in the Strait of Hormuz — A Total Violation of our Ceasefire Agreement!" he wrote.

He paired the accusation with a stark warning. "NO MORE MR. NICE GUY!" Trump declared, saying that if Tehran refused a deal, the United States was "going to knock out every single Power Plant, and every single Bridge, in Iran."

'Fair and reasonable deal'

"We're offering a very fair and reasonable DEAL, and I hope they take it," he said, while calling the upcoming talks Iran's "last chance." Speaking to Fox News, Trump warned: "If Iran does not sign this deal, the whole country is getting blown up."

The remarks underscore growing pressure ahead of negotiations as the standoff in the Strait of Hormuz deepens. Iran's Revolutionary Guard navy said the waterway would

UAE HAS RIGHT TO GUARANTEES, COMPENSATION

Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has said the UAE has the right to seek guarantees to prevent the repetition of cowardly Iranian attacks and to be compensated after the Iranian aggression against GCC countries. "The Iranian regime has attacked everyone in the Gulf, even those acting as intermediaries", Gargash said during a media session organised by the Dubai Press Club.

"The UAE is clear and has legitimate concerns over Iran's nuclear programme, ballistic missiles and drones, adding that while Iran may seek guarantees and compensation, the UAE has an equal right to demand guarantees against the repetition of Iranian attacks, and compensation," Gargash remarked.

"We totally realise that many Arab societies view Israel as their first enemy, however perspectives in the Gulf may differ after Iran had launched thousands of missiles and drones against GCC countries. This is why we do not trust Iran and see it as a main enemy," Gargash concluded.

— Khitam Al Amir, Chief News Editor

remain closed as long as the US blockade of Iranian ports continues, warning that any vessel attempting to pass could be treated as cooperating with the enemy.

The escalation has raised fresh concerns about global energy flows, with the strait effectively shut to most traffic after a brief reopening collapsed.

A British maritime agency reported Iranian gunboats fired at a tanker, while another vessel was hit by a projectile that damaged containers. A third ship was reportedly threatened as it attempted to leave the Gulf. Trump reacted: "That wasn't nice, was it?"

Even as tensions rise, talks are moving ahead. Trump said US negotiators would arrive in Islamabad today, adding that Vice-President JD Vance would

not attend due to security concerns. The previous round of talks lasted just 21 hours and ended without agreement.

Core issues unresolved

Negotiators remain far apart on core issues — including Iran's uranium stockpile, sanctions relief and the future of the Strait of Hormuz, which Tehran has tied to lifting the US blockade.

The gaps are deepened by competing ceasefire claims, Iran's missile and drone rebuild, and its use of Hormuz disruption as a new pressure tool.

With the ceasefire set to expire Wednesday, the gap between rhetoric and reality is widening — and the risk of renewed conflict is growing.

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